

World of Work

1. New Trends/Developments

1.1 Great Resignation

- 4.2 Million Americans quit their jobs in October 2021
- Employee retention is top priority for organizations
- Reasons behind this trend are multi-faceted (not only pandemic)
- High percentage want to switch their jobs
- Overall number actually want to quit
 - Reasons: poor leadership, lack of remote work as an option, limited visibility in terms of career paths

<https://emeritus.org/blog/strategies-for-employee-retention/>

<https://www.marketwatch.com/story/you-have-to-say-i-do-before-i-quit-according-to-this-analysis-of-the-jobs-market-11637247723>

1.2 Remote and Hybrid Work

- strongly due to the pandemic
- has affected millions of workers worldwide
- flexjobs survey: 58 % want fully remote post-pandemic, 39 % prefer hybrid

<https://www.flexjobs.com/blog/post/workers-quit-employers-revoke-remote-work/>

<https://www.pwc.com/us/en/services/consulting/workforce-of-the-future/library/touchstone-survey.html>

1.3 Prioritization of Employee Well-Being

- Companies focus on work-life balance and mental health
- This provides benefits like greater flexibility
- 53 % of employers added mental health programs

1.4 Talent Shortages and Reskilling Within Organizations

- skills required in many industries are changing
- 7 in 10 companies reported talent shortages
- Companies struggle to fill open roles
 - One Solution is to retrain existing employees

[https://go.manpowergroup.com/talent-](https://go.manpowergroup.com/talent-shortage#:~:text=Nearly%207%20in%2010%20(69,to%20respond%20to%20today's%20trend)

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1.5 A Focus on Skills Over Jobs

- Upskill employees become more attractive to close skill gaps
- Skills can be measured using “skill data”

<https://emeritus.org/blog/how-to-upskill-employees/>

<https://hrdailyadvisor.blr.com/2021/06/24/what-is-skill-data/>

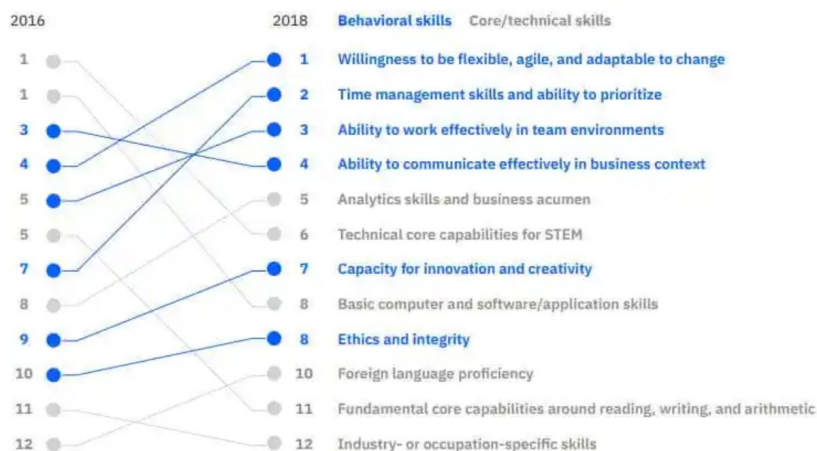
1.6 Emphasis on Soft Skills

- The need to build relationships virtually and work with reduced oversight has made soft skills more important.



Figure 1

Executives now point to behavioral skills as the most critical for members of the workforce today



Sources: 2016 IBM Institute for Business Value Global Skills Survey; 2018 IBM Institute for Business Value Global Country Survey.

<https://joshbersin.com/2019/10/lets-stop-talking-about-soft-skills-theyre-power-skills/>
<https://emeritus.org/blog/soft-skills-in-the-workplace/>

1.7 Increased Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Efforts

- Nearly 80% of U.S. workers want to work for companies that make DEI a priority
- In 2021 diversity and inclusion was the No. 1 area of focus for businesses to attract talent

<https://www.cnbc.com/2021/04/30/diversity-equity-and-inclusion-are-important-to-workers-survey-shows.html>

1.8 Greater Use of AI and Automation

- They have improved and expedited internal processes, increased employee engagement
- Skill employees need to achieve are changing

<https://emeritus.org/blog/pros-and-cons-of-automation-in-the-workplace/>

1.9 Transformation of HR Using Tech and Data

- People analytics helps employers uncover important information about employees' individual need
- Companies are turning to cloud computing, collaboration technologies, and digitization to improve HR (Human Resources)

<https://www.mckinsey.com/solutions/orgsolutions/overview/people-analytics>

<https://www.shrm.org/resourcesandtools/hr-topics/technology/pages/analytics-digital-transformation-will-shape-hr-post-pandemic.aspx>

1.10 An Emphasis on Continued Employee Growth

- Leaders aim to embed a growth mindset into their culture
- This stems from the belief that you have the capacity to learn and grow
- This contrasts with a fixed mindset (talent is innate)
- Microsoft and Unilever have made this type of organization-wide growth



<https://emeritus.org/blog/growth-mindset-in-the-workplace/>

2. New means of communication in the workplace

- tools like Slack, Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Jell, and Twist optimize messaging across organizations
- Effective communication is a two-way street
- A clear context leads to a clear message

<https://firstup.io/blog/workplace-communication-its-now-more-important-than-ever/>

3. Unemployment

= is the state of not having a job because you have been made redundant or fired.

- In times of crises, companies can switch to short-time work so they don't have to lay off any workers
- The trade union usually makes sure that a social-compensation plan is worked out if a large number of the personnel has to be made redundant
- Bigger companies have foundations, which offer retrainings for their former members of staff